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11/03/2026
SOCI.102.01
Immigrants and Taxes

- How much in taxes do immigrants (documented and undocumented) contribute to taxes each year? (*Short answer)*

According to the article, immigrants pay a lot more taxes than many people would be led to believe, and that immigrants typically pay more than their fair share. The article cites Immigration Impact, claiming that immigrants contribute $383 billion to federal taxes and $196 to state and local taxes annually. In Texas, immigrants make up more than one fifth of the labor force and $15 billion dollars in state and local taxes. In states with a lower percentage of immigrants, such as Iowa, their contribution to taxes is still quite large at around $631 million in state and local taxes every year. The social security administration has estimated that undocumented workers pay $13 billion into the system and have a sum contribution of $100 billion in the last ten years.

- What sort of things/programs do immigrants' taxes support? (*Short answer)*
    - Are immigrants able to benefit from these things/programs? (*Short answer)*

Immigrants' taxes support lots of industries and programs such as education, Social Security, Medicaid, and Medicare. However, since these programs only give benefits to citizens or documented immigrants, they cannot apply for benefits under them.

- What does all of this tell us about the immigration system of the United States? Why is this important? (***Long answer - elaborate; connect to other course materials)***

This tells us that there is a false narrative prevailing in our society that undocumented and documented immigrants take more than they give, which according to the information in the article is entirely false. In fact, it is likely the opposite, that immigrants pay on average more than a U.S citizen in taxes. Documented immigrants are receiving benefits they have lawfully paid into via taxes, and undocumented immigrants are still paying into these systems without receiving the benefits. This is important because it means that the narrative that immigrants are freeloading off these systems is fabricated and is not representative of the truth. This means that this narrative is being pushed for reasons other than the good of the truth. As brought up in the article Racism and Capitalism by Alan Spector, Racism and Capitalism are intertwined, and that capitalism cannot exist without some form of exploitation or oppression towards a group of people. Industries and Cooperations are able to benefit from the perpetuation of immigrants by

creating class structures and power relationships that uphold a system of control. By pushing the narrative that immigrants are inherently freeloaders, it distracts the public from realizing that the real minority taking more than they give is the top one percent.